

face of the army. 'Little Phil' was the supreme incarnation of war." Sheridan's Ride was commemorated in a poem of that name, which so delighted Sheridan that he changed the name of his black charger, Rienzi, to Winchester.

In April 1865, it was Sheridan who cut Lee's final avenue of escape at Appomattox. "Sheridan's pursuit of Lee," in Grant's opinion, "was perfect in its generalship and energy." Some officers still resented his success, and Sheridan, moreover, had his problems with military authority. In 1862, he had been arrested on a charge of insubordination, and three years later on the battlefield at Five Forks, he summarily stripped General Gouverneur K. Warren of his corps command for reasons later deemed untenable. Yet Theodore Lyman of George Meade's staff spoke for most officers when he grudgingly admitted, "Sherman is our first military genius, while Sheridan is most remarkable as a 'field fighter,' when the battle is actually engaged."

Grant was chief of the many who envied the field fighter's battlefield magnetism. "Gallant Phil" himself, however, merely ascribed it to his penchant for fighting alongside his men. At the Battle of Stones River, where he pulled his division out of the shattered grove of cedars that they had defended against repeated Confederate attacks, while losing a third of their comrades, Sheridan was bareheaded, having lost his hat in the melee. After the battle, his soldiers honored him by providing him with one of their own.

Sheridan was unsparing of himself and never spared others. He was curt, sarcastic, and combative even with his staff, and his picturesque profanity was legendary. In a rout of Confederate cavalry at the Battle of Five Forks, he galloped all over the field, urging his men on to greater efforts: "Come on; go at 'em! They're all getting ready to run now!" Even when one soldier collapsed before him, blood spurting from his neck, Sheridan, declaring he was not a bit hurt, ordered him to pick up his gun and get moving.

After the war Sheridan, headstrong and undiplomatic as ever, continued to flourish in army life. For years he was effectively in charge of the Indian wars in the West, where his opponents